



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Dominion Christian School
School Website: <https://www.dominionschool.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Dominion Christian School (Oakton, VA, 22124) presents a robust, clearly classical Christian program. Public-facing materials consistently frame the school as a classical institution with a Christian–theological foundation, a Trivium-based curriculum, and an emphasis on great books, formation of character, and virtuous living. The site explicitly describes Dominion as a K-12 classical college-preparatory school and highlights virtues, Augustine's thought, and a faith-centered approach to learning. These signals align strongly with the Six Essential Elements framework, indicating a predominantly CLASSICAL orientation across categories. Evidence from the school's public materials includes references to classical education, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and formation of character through faith and virtue. See sources noting Dominion as a classical Christian school and discussions of the Trivium and Great Books on the school site.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The school identifies itself as a classical Christian school and foregrounds faith in Jesus Christ, Augustine's rightly-ordered loves, and a theologically integrated perspective. Positive keywords such as theology, virtue, wisdom, and sacred tradition appear in the public materials. Negative keywords (secular, relativism, values-neutral) are not present in these materials. **Why:** The public materials emphasize transcendental, theological, and sacred dimensions of education, with explicit Christian formation and virtue-aligned aims. **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Strong presence of positive religious/metaphysical indicators (e.g., faith, Augustine, theology, virtue, wisdom) and no clear negative indicators in the public materials. Expect a high positive-to-negative ratio consistent with CLASSICAL.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Mission language centers on forming virtuous, thoughtful people who pursue truth, goodness, and beauty rather than merely obtaining credentials or job preparation. The public statements emphasize forming humanity, not solely work-readiness. Positive keywords related to formation, virtue, wisdom, and transcendental aims are evident. **Why:** The school's stated purpose aligns with formation over information and with knowledge of transcendentals, i.e., truth, goodness, and beauty. **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Multiple positive indicators (formation, virtue, wisdom, truth/goodness/beauty) with no explicit negative indicators in the materials. Predominantly CLASSICAL.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The site and materials emphasize the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and a liberal-arts framing, plus a history of Western civilization and integration of disciplines. The Trivium is described in public-facing content, and Great Books / Great Conversation themes appear in Dominion's materials. **Why:** The curriculum emphasis on grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, and integrated study fits the classical liberal-arts model. **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Positive keywords include Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great

Books, and cross-disciplinary integration. No explicit countervailing negatives found in public content. CLASSICAL.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence: Dominion's materials repeatedly frame education around the Trivium and classical pedagogy (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, and inquiry-oriented discussion around foundational texts. While explicit "Socratic seminars" are not always named, the Trivium-based approach and the emphasis on disciplined discussion and classical methods signal a pedagogical framework consistent with classical education. Why: The pedagogy signals align with a classical approach, including the emphasis on foundational disciplines and disciplined inquiry. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include grammar/logic/rhetoric, great books, and classical discussion. No clear negative pedagogical signals detected in public materials. CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: The site presents a visible leadership/teacher structure (Head of School, Lower School Principal, Humanities faculty, etc.) and a "Meet the Faculty" section. Faculty are positioned as part of the school's identity (e.g., Leadership & Faculty pages) consistent with the classical model of teachers as mentors and as the living curriculum. Why: The public-facing faculty structure and content reflect mentors modeling virtue and expertise, a core classical criterion. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include terms like "Head of School," "Faculty," "Leadership," and named roles; no negative faculty indicators appear in public content. CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Dominion publishes parent-facing materials (e.g., A Parent's Guide to Choosing a School, admission resources, and a "Current Families" portal) and emphasizes parent involvement within a classical framework. The presence of parent resources and opportunities to tour/visit signals a partnership with families consistent with classical education. Why: The public materials indicate active parent involvement and partnership in the educational project, a key criterion for CLASSICAL. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include parent-focused materials and family involvement language; negative indicators (e.g., consumerism, minimal parent involvement) are not evident in the public materials. CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment: Based on keyword-driven scoring across all six categories, Dominion Christian School (Oakton, VA, 22124) aligns with a CLASSICAL classification. The explicit constitutional identity as a classical Christian school, the Trivium curriculum, Great Books framing, formation-focused mission, and active faculty and parent engagement collectively point toward a cohesive CLASSICAL orientation rather than only SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL or NOT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required. The school already demonstrates a cohesive CLASSICAL orientation across religious/metaphysical foundations, purpose and goals, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parents/community in its public materials. If desired, minor enhancements could include explicitly naming and describing Scholé-inspired routines (restful learning) or clearly signaling Socratic seminars and memory/recitation practices as a regular pedagogical method in grade bands to strengthen alignment with all six elements in the lexicon.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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